Nutrient deficiencies in plants

Plants take up **inorganic nutrients** through their roots. Some soils don't have a good range of nutrients. When this happens the soil is nutrient deficient, and the plants cannot get all the nutrients they need. The table below lists symptoms common in plants that are **deficient** in major nutrients.

☞ **1** Fill in the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u).

	Nitrogen	**Phosphorus**	**Potassium**
Needed for	Regulates ch__m__c__l reactions, also stem and l__ __f growth	Root formation, fl__w__r__ng, fruiting and ripening	Fr__ __t__ng, flowers and gr__w__ng tips, also for ph__t__synth__s__s at low light levels
Deficiency signs	Leaves turn pale gr__ __n to yellow	St__nt__d growth, dark leaf c__l__ __r, poor flowering __nd fruiting	Spotted older l__ __v__s with dry edges. Weak stems and uneven fr__ __t ripening.
Remedy	Urine, all types of animal m__n__r__, fish and f__ __th__rs	Bonemeal, b__rd manure	S__ __w__ __d, wood ash

2 Separate the words below to make sentences.

Plantswithyellowleavesmayhaveanitrogendeficiency.

_____

Addingbirdmanuretothesoilwillincresenitrogenlevels.

_____

Heavyraincanwashnitrogenoutofsandysoils.

_____

3 What deficiency would the following plant have?

_____



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